



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 6

COLORADO

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Colorado's family courts and child-welfare system.

74

COLORADO FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
94 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 21
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 13, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

23 OF 64

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

COLORADO AT A GLANCE.

Across 74 Colorado families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 94 74 of 74 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$191,245 median across 34 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 21 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 67.6% 35.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 74	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.3	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 74 of 74	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 23

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Colorado families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF COLORADO FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	36	\$30,000	\$93,558	\$3,368,089
Lost Wages	37	\$33,000	\$247,246	\$9,148,110
Other Court Fees	30	\$2,500	\$12,864	\$385,911
Therapy / Evaluations	32	\$3,250	\$12,722	\$407,120
Reunification Services	26	\$1,500	\$7,203	\$187,279
GAL Fees	24	\$1,650	\$2,583	\$62,000
Asset Loss ¹	37	\$35,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (34 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$191,245	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$35,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		21	1.8 yrs
Mean months lost		42	3.5 yrs
Total across all families		2,004	167 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · COLORADO

Most families documenting in Colorado are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		34	46%
Not provided		16	22%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		13	18%
Case closed: within last 2 years		7	9%
Active case: progress being made		3	4%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		30	41%
Both Family Court and CPS		25	34%
Unknown		12	16%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		7	9%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		22	30%
Over 10 years		12	16%
5 – 10 years		12	16%
3 – 5 years		10	14%
5+ years		6	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		23	31%
Visitation Only		17	23%
50/50 Joint		14	19%
Full Custody		12	16%
Partial / Shared		3	4%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

El Paso		10	14%
Weld		5	7%
Pueblo		4	5%
Douglas		4	5%
Jefferson		4	5%
Arapahoe		4	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		23	31%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		13	18%
High Conflict Divorce		9	12%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)		6	8%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)		4	5%

04 PARENT VOICES — COLORADO

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Colorado comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or [...]

— COLIN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

A lawyer who has repeatedly made false accusations, with no evidence.

— COLORADO PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM COLORADO

The system has destroyed my son. ,my Family my life my finances, and my local welding business .,My son was ripped away from his aunt ,brothers, cousins, community , friends and school and me his father, and moved 540 miles away. All based upon false allegations ,and proven lies [...]

— KENNETH

They destroyed my hole family and have stolen child support funds ordered to be paid to us by the courts

— PAMELA

Destroyed myself and children for a lifetime. My daughter's both have PTSD, severe anxiety and depression. My son has reactive attachment disorder and Severe Intellectual disability resulting in possibility of never being able to live on his own. My daughter now 15 refuses to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" [...]

— JUSTIN

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated and destroyed siblings bonding and growing up together. Traumatizing children and retraumatizing the adult who was abused by vindictive adopted parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My case has been twisted for years. And there is another mother of his children in CO who just lost her lawyers, due to the enormous amount of cost in six months. The judge is allowing him to not submit documents and going off his word, without proof. The judge just ruled in my [...]

— COURTNEY

It has traumatized my kids and myself in ways that I believe are irreparable

— CHARLENE

Family court is where the Constitution of the United States is best used to wipe ones ass, Judges and attorneys know it, lies and false accusations are normal and truth does not matter.

— MIKE

Lied, manipulated , and legally stole my child, who had already been traumatized. They put my child back in harms way, they took my child and left me helpless no thought of reunification, the entire time they were working for the man who assaulted my child. They were well versed [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I no longer have a family, divorced my ex and she took the kids with the help of the courts and the judge.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Weld County CPS is full of bad actors and corruption. A literal threat made by a caseworker to myself, "I am the end all, be all of this case."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Robbed my children of their childhood and connection with their mother for 5 years. Provided them with childhood trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Freedom of speech doesn't exist with CPS. I sent an email asserting my parental rights, then I lost everything that I love in this world. 12 straight years of being a single father—did not matter

— SAMUEL

This system didn't just separate me from my children—it took years of love, connection, and memories we can never replace.

— ALYSSA

It's destroyed me inside and out.

— KASSY

I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless fkr a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and [...]

— JASON

Legalized abuse. Kidnapped and tortured childhood and parenthood. Created everlasting trauma for child and safe parent. There truly are not words. Humanitarian Crisis for profit. Pure Evil.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed us and caused trauma and damages for our future

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— ANDREW

Stripped me of my title as a mom

— MIRANDA

Stolen my son, violating rights to safety and love for both of us. I waited to be a mom, and didn't want to miss any of it but now I'm prevented from all and he's in a home of horror.

— MARY

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Family court has helped these evil people steal my children and keep them from me for a good part of almost 7 years when I am an exceptional mother and this has been so traumatic for all 3 of my children and myself.

— CANDICE

Put me in jail, emotionally traumatized me and my daughter, and had to start my life completely over from scratch.

— CHRIS

They've torn us apart and impacted our family in a very traumatic and or traumatized both my child and myself!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was a former DHS staff member who exposed cover-ups of deaths of 7 children and covered-up kidnappings 2008-2021 in Pueblo County. I have the EEOC charges and unpublished recordings of closed door meetings, including one with now ex-Mayor, who was an law partners who shared [...]

— MICHELLE

I never thought I would grieve the life of a deceased child, let alone my living children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has completely destabilized myself and my two children. It is devastating and I'm still dealing with the grief of the aftermath.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped is apart, tortured our son, drowned him to silence him, then continued kidnapping my kids in efforts to break my spirit and discredit me to avoid accountability for drowning Jayden. They keep taking my kids without reason but the fosters who drown Jayden never lost their [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My wife has stage 4 cancer and they removed her child on the child's birthday. The system is using caregiving as an excuse for neglect.

— CLAYTON

Destroyed my relationship with my child and enabled my abuser to continue abusing myself using the system as their tool. Have suffered irreparable physical, mental, and financial harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Used the system to take the one thing that would hurt me to lose.

— AMANDA

The system destroyed my family and now as my adult daughter still deals with the repercussions to this day, I know something needs to be done now to stop this!

— AMANDA

Torn us apart. Lack of due process nearly destroyed a close relationship between mother and son

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Colorado courts are a cesspool of misconduct and corruption. The states private attorneys/lawyers are completely unethical. Both treat Colorado's own state constitution, Colorado Supreme Court precedent, and federal supremacy as optional, in fact they completely disregard and [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system left me living in a camper while rewarding the man who harmed us, and taught my daughters to value resources over safety.

— JULIE

Denied justice due process and it cost me everything. Now I feel like I'm being harassed by child support.

— MARK

My son (and daughter, in a separate case) were torn away from me based on completely untrue allegations made by my vindictive ex. It cost me the first 5 years of my sons life, cost me 4 years of my young daughters life, but the cost to my kids has been severe childhood trauma [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system continues to show me that it is all about the money who has it who can pay more. The best interest of children is not at the forefront of the court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This family court rewarded parental alienation, restricted my relationship with my children, and gave sole decision-making authority to the parent creating barriers to our bond, despite evidence of withheld parenting time, denied contact, and gatekeeping. At the same time, it [...]

— ANDREW

51 Colorado parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — COLORADO

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Colorado families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or reported to and investigations are shut down. Police records have been deleted and IA had to be conducted in order to solve the issue of deletion; however no actions were taken in our cases. Douglas and Arapahoe County had to be separated so they couldn't shift their magistrates and judges to hide them from their Brady violations. They is a huge network of broken system thugs that are here for the money but not best interest of your children. CFI, PREs are a joke. PRE sexually assaulted another, lied and abused its power and the county called him a reputable firm and to not talk about him in that disrespectful manner. Zero continuity in cases with magistrates where if they screw up or realize they have been lied to they leave your case, I've been through 15 magistrates and one judge. In the end the system is a joke, politicians want you to know they care but they don't protect your kids and most philosophy's are in place not laws to protect children. Look up divorce marketing magazine, where you see professionals share their testimony's prior to court to gain business from other attorneys. Hard to take down a fraudulent billion dollar business plan supported by politicians because they are the ones appointing the magistrates from property law.

— COLIN

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— KENNETH

They destroyed my hole family and have stolen child support funds ordered to be paid to us by the courts

— PAMELA

Destroyed myself and children for a lifetime. My daughter's both have PTSD, severe anxiety and depression. My son has reactive attachment disorder and Severe Intellectual disability resulting in possibility of never being able to live on his own. My daughter now 15 refuses to see a counselor for depression for extreme fear of CPS after what they did to her. My oldest daughter now 19, still struggles with trust issues and trusts no counselor. CPS has harassed me every year since coming home over false accusations which has resulted in us never being able to heal or move past the past. Now my kids constantly worry what and when will be next this year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" act is a fraud; she hasn't been left alone—she has intentionally forced the father out to prioritize her own emotional grievances. She has kept this case open for 14 months by perpetually manufacturing new "safety concerns" every time the old ones are proven false, stalling any hope of progress to protect her own image. My reactive responses are not the cause of this conflict; they are the direct result of having the truth suppressed for an entire year. She carries this on because she would rather burn the whole house down than engage in the self-reflection and growth required to provide a stable home. To admit the truth now would be to admit she spent a year traumatizing her own sons for a personal vendetta while dismissing her own destructive behavior. The reality is simple: I am not a threat to my sons, and I am not a threat to Elizabeth. I am only a threat to the narrative she has built. You don't protect your children by erasing their father; you protect your own ego by erasing the truth, even if it means destroying the very foundation they were supposed to stand on.

— JUSTIN

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as coercive control and mental abuse through family therapy and visits. Children's rights, wishes and best interests are not followed but instead the abuser gets rights while his victims are scrutinized.

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My case has been twisted for years. And there is another mother of his children in CO who just lost her lawyers, due to the enormous amount of cost in six months. The judge is allowing him to not submit documents and going off his word, without proof. The judge just ruled in my case without even pretrial, based on his accusations. My kids are being subjected to manipulation, trauma, and harm because the courts won't do their job according to the law.

— COURTNEY

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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It's destroyed me inside and out.

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I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless for a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and magistrates that enable these things should be made to forfeit their places to live despite the contents of their bank accounts to see how it feels. It's unforgivable to hurt children and loving parents for personal profits and state revenue. Disgusting.

— JASON

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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This family court rewarded parental alienation, restricted my relationship with my children, and gave sole decision-making authority to the parent creating barriers to our bond, despite evidence of withheld parenting time, denied contact, and gatekeeping. At the same time, it imposed financial orders based on unsupported income assumptions that created impossible obligations, pushing me into debt while weakening my ability to remain a stable and present father in my children's lives.

— ANDREW

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system tried to kill me and erase my from my child's life. My ex manipulated my own family and tried to get them to testify against me as harshly as possible so as to do th most damage that he possibly could. My son was only three years old and was ripped away from me. I was a stay at home mom for most of his life by that point. I had only just begun to go back to school and work when my ex and I separated. My son was still breastfeeding and my mother and grandmother do not act in good faith, they covertly chose to side against me because my ex had the money. My mom secretly also was trying to take my son for her own even though that was never even up for discussion. Also my mom's boyfriend at the also testified against me as a police officer because he was mad I didn't let my mom borrow my car to visit him in the middle of the night during a snowstorm. My reliable vehicle was my only way to get to and from work at the time so I could pay my attorney fees and I could not let her take it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's made me feel like I'm not a Good Mother. Even though I know I do my best as a Single Mother. It's Harassing me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated us,.... Lives and memories lost,.... Its affected my health tremendously Iv always thought they placed her with Unsafe people they have a criminal background and guns in there homes I put photos in my book the missing that shows photos of my daughter near guns they have other kids also near guns and weaponry,.....

— LINDSEY

Complete destruction of ability to thrive, depleting my parents retirement savings, extreme constant stress to child, me, my parents my siblings and their children. Straining and diminishing any/all meaningful relationships as this is too much for anyone close to hear in detail, but it's our entire life.

— AUBREE

Taking my daughter as an infant, when her father was absent. Not taking breastfeeding seriously, or developmental needs. Ignoring doctors and specialists. Ignoring evidence of substance use around child and witness testimony.

— JANELLE

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The Magistrate belittled me for an hour at the last hearing. Threatening to take my child away from me because I wasn't "flexable". All because I was following the court order. No where can anyone show me a law or state statute that mandates me to be flexible instead in leu of a court order.

— KELLEY

The system is built on, whoever makes the loudest accusations or has the most money I came to court with timeline, documented evidence, and proof of competence... it was dismissed and I was restricted even after proof through DHS clearing me NO FINDINGS.

— EVELYNN

it has ruined my family's dynamic, we used to be close and now all of us have a form of ptsd and are experiencing that in the courts. we do not trust these caseworkers to ever do their jobs properly.

— PRISCILLA

Thank you doing you job and insuring my child wer safe my home and my ex's. Partner callses really helped him do better and stop blaming other for his short coming. None of it would have been possible without the child protective services.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

51 full approved Colorado comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Colorado report comes from Colorado respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Colorado — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 74 Colorado families reporting here are not the universe of Colorado families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

[STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com) · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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